

Chapter 33 - Feedback

Yan Lin stood frozen at the entrance of the study, and for a moment all the noise around her fell silent. All she could hear in her ears was a prolonged, rumbling white noise.

The gift she had given to Feng Yue—why was it appearing here? Or had she mistaken it for something else?

Mr. Chu, who had been waiting for Yan Lin in the study, saw her enter and smiled in good spirits: "Little Yan is here, please sit."

Yan Lin seemed not to have heard him, only standing there motionlessly. Mo Yixu thought his boss was thinking about other matters, so he spoke up to remind her.

Yan Lin snapped back to reality at the sound of Mo Yixu's voice. She knew very clearly why she had come to see Mr. Chu today, so after just a moment, she shifted her gaze away from that potted flower.

"Uncle Chu, good afternoon."

Her purpose for coming here today was to win over Mr. Chu, this elder who was about the same age as her father and who held the most shares in Yan Corporation outside of the Yan family themselves.

In the upcoming annual board meeting, she needed his support.

Yan Lin took a folder from Mo Yixu's hands, then calmly explained her intentions with an even expression.

Mr. Chu and Father Yan were very good friends, and he was quite fond of Yan Lin as a junior.

Mr. Chu listened quietly to Yan Lin's explanation, secretly startled by this child's ambition and foresight.

If Yan Lin hadn't come to find him in advance today, but had directly proposed this decision at the board meeting, he believed that those supporting Yan Lin would definitely not reach half the members.

Mr. Chu was also someone who had fought his way through the business world, so he naturally understood the principle of high risk, high reward. But the decision Yan Lin proposed was truly too risky.

He pondered silently, as if considering something. Yan Lin stopped speaking as well, allowing Mr. Chu to consider carefully.

Yan Lin leaned back quietly on the sofa, but her gaze unconsciously fell on the flower pot placed on the windowsill.

The flower didn't seem to be well-cared for, looking somewhat wilted, and even the color of the petals seemed somewhat dim.

Yan Lin's heart was in chaos. She could now be certain that this flower was the one she had given to Feng Yue.

But why had it appeared at Mr. Chu's place?

Yan Lin stared at it quietly, feeling as if a hand was tightly gripping her throat, making her experience a sense of suffocation.

"Little Yan, how confident are you?" After a long while, Mr. Chu spoke up.

Yan Lin quickly withdrew her gaze, looking toward the documents on the table as if to cover something, then said: "Eighty percent certainty." In reality, with her previous life's experience, Yan Lin could achieve one hundred percent certainty.

Mr. Chu drew in a sharp breath, secretly shocked. You had to know that in a high-risk project, being able to guarantee a fifty percent success rate was already quite remarkable.

And Yan Lin opened her mouth with eighty percent certainty.

This was clearly telling Mr. Chu that this project would only succeed, not fail.

If these words had come from anyone else, Mr. Chu would have thought they were talking nonsense.

But now these words came from Yan Lin.

Mr. Chu looked at this junior sitting before him, this child he had watched grow up. He suddenly felt that his current hesitant and indecisive self truly seemed old.

Mr. Chu sighed lightly, then made up his mind and said: "Alright, I will agree."

Yan Lin nodded, stood up and bowed to Mr. Chu: "Thank you, Uncle Chu."

Mr. Chu's expression seemed somewhat melancholy. He shook his head and reached out to pat her shoulder: "I'm old. This era ultimately belongs to you young people. Go ahead and do it boldly—I still trust my own judgment."

Yan Lin nodded slightly at him, then straightened up to leave. But the moment she walked out of the study, she still paused.

"Uncle Chu."

"Hmm? What is it?"

Yan Lin turned around, her gaze passing over the elder before her and falling on the windowsill, asking in a light voice: "The flower on your windowsill blooms so beautifully. Where did you buy it?"

Mr. Chu was somewhat surprised, but when it came to this matter, he became happy.

"This flower was obtained from a flower enthusiast on a forum. It's a newly cultivated rose variety, and this breed was bought out¹ at the cultivation base—there's probably only this one plant in the entire world."

Mr. Chu became happier as he spoke, even his eyebrows lifting: "Actually, saying I 'obtained' it isn't quite accurate—they didn't charge me any money. It was given to me. Her conditions for giving it away were quite strict, but that's understandable—she was afraid I'd resell it."

Mo Yixu stood outside the door waiting, and Mr. Chu's words fell on his ears, making him increasingly alarmed.

A bought-out cultivated rose variety.

Why did that sound so familiar?

Mo Yixu slightly turned his head to look toward the windowsill, and this glance made him gasp.

Good heavens, this flower looked so familiar, and combined with Mr. Chu's description—wasn't this exactly the rose variety that President Yan had previously ordered from abroad?

But... hadn't President Yan used it as a gift for Miss Feng?

Mo Yixu was full of questions, and Yan Lin wasn't doing much better.

She listened silently as Mr. Chu rambled on about the flower's origins. Only after he finished speaking did she step toward the windowsill.

Yan Lin stood before the windowsill, looking at the bright red border lines on the petals. As if possessed, she reached out her hand, but just as she was about to touch the petals, she stopped her movement.

Yan Lin's slender figure seemed to collapse in an instant. She lowered her head, her hair falling along her cheeks, making it impossible to see her expression at that moment.

"Uncle Chu, may I take a photo of your flower?"

Mr. Chu was shocked by the sudden melancholy emanating from Yan Lin's body, and only nodded: "Uh, of course."

Yan Lin didn't continue speaking. She just silently took out her phone, framed the flower's most beautiful appearance in the viewfinder, then pressed the shutter button.

"Click—"

The gift she had given her had, in the blink of an eye, become completely unrelated to them.

Mr. Chu, who was completely confused, still didn't understand why this child would be interested in a potted flower on his windowsill, even after seeing off this junior.

When Yan Lin returned to the car, she seemed to have lost her soul: "Take me back to the hotel." After speaking, she raised the partition inside the car.

Finally alone in the small rear compartment, Yan Lin finally allowed herself to furrow her brow in distress.

Her longing for Feng Yue was growing wildly in her heart. She wanted to see her, wanted to embrace her, wanted to breathe in her scent.

But she knew that everything she wanted was in vain.

Yan Lin was like a drowning person sinking into the deep sea, tremblingly reaching out her hand to tightly grasp the ring hanging around her neck. It seemed to her like the only piece of driftwood on the ocean surface.

She bent over, the ring clutched in her palm, pressing painfully against her. But she seemed to feel nothing, even gripping it tighter and tighter.

The pain in her heart came much more fiercely than the pain in her hand.

As soon as Feng Yue's video was released, it was picked up by netizens who had recently been bored out of their minds and spread around.

Netizens with good memories still remembered Feng Yue, while those without memory also remembered her when they saw those familiar hands that appeared on screen.

In the video, only the four friends from that day appeared on camera, while Feng Yue herself, as before, only showed her slender, fair hands on screen.

On the day the video was released, all four people who appeared on camera coincidentally reposted Feng Yue's shared video on Weibo.

Among the four, Dai Shuangshuang was a blogger familiar to netizens, but the other three who emerged would give these gossiping netizens small surprises when they clicked on any of their accounts.

The daughter of an entertainment company, a principal dancer of a theater troupe, a renowned jewelry designer.

These seemingly unrelated people were connected through a small food blogger who had just released her first video.

Thus, Feng Yue's identity once again became everyone's most curious thing.

However, Feng Yue herself rarely used social media platforms like Weibo, so netizens mostly had nothing to dig into.

The only way to glimpse her life was through that live stream replay.

So a group of idle netizens clicked on that live stream replay again.

And Yan Lin, who had quietly watched Feng Yue's live stream at the time, returned to the netizens' attention.

Combined with the presence of Wen Zhen, the daughter of a well-known entertainment company, among the gathering participants, a group of bored marketing accounts caught wind and began carefully examining the traces Feng Yue's account had left online over the years.

By the time Feng Yue learned about this matter, two days had passed since the video's release.

She had been exhausted from editing the video the past few days, and since it had been a while since she'd visited her parents, she had gone home for a brief two-day stay.

So when Wen Zhen called to apologize, she was still completely confused about the situation.

Feng Yue logged into Weibo on her computer, holding her phone to her ear while talking with Wen Zhen.

"Sorry, A Yue, I'll have someone handle these online comments," Wen Zhen's apologetic voice sounded in Feng Yue's ear.

Feng Yue roughly browsed through her comment section. Actually, it wasn't too bad—there weren't any extreme comments, and most people showed more curiosity than malice toward her.

However, seeing that most private messages and comments were asking about her relationship with Yan Lin, she still felt somewhat helplessly irritated.

Feng Yue spoke to comfort her: "Actually, it's fine. You don't need to handle it. Everyone doesn't have any ill intentions."

"As long as you don't mind, then I'll handle this matter."

When Wen Zhen was young, she was beautiful and well-loved by the big stars in her father's company. Her mother was also a renowned dancer, so she had never lacked attention from childhood.

As she grew older, she began to dislike this feeling of being overly scrutinized—it was like being stripped naked and thrown onto the street for people to observe.

She hated this, so when choosing a university, she directly picked a school abroad.

Then during university, she gradually fell in love with cooking. Delicious food could calm her anxiety, so after returning to China, she never joined her father's company but opened her own private kitchen outside.

Until this time, Wen Zhen had appeared in everyone's sight again because of her background, and Feng Yue had suffered collateral damage.

Feng Yue had no objection to Wen Zhen wanting to handle this matter. She comforted Wen Zhen a few more times before hanging up.

At this time, the public relations department of Yan Corporation detected that their President Yan's name had caused small-scale discussion.

The head of the public relations department immediately contacted Mo Yixu, the special assistant.

Footnotes:

¹ "买断" (mǎi duàn) - In Chinese horticulture/breeding context, this refers to when someone purchases exclusive rights to a plant variety, meaning they own the sole right to propagate and sell that particular cultivar.